achieve an authentic farmhouse feel. This required a shift in mindset for both the owner and the craftsmen. "I'd tell the plasterer I didn't want a perfect finish, and he'd be confused because everyone else fights him for perfection," he says. "But achieving that 'imperfect' look actually requires immense precision to ensure it feels intentional, not unfinished."

Sustainability as a Standard

Parambil sees environmental responsibility as fundamental to problem-solving. Whether it's a 7,500 sq ft mansion or a modest residence, the starting point is always the same: site, context and climate. "The most basic thing a designer should do is respond to the climate," he asserts. By using deep overhangs and strategic light orientations, he reduces a building's footprint while enhancing the living experience. In his view, sustainability isn't an add-on; it's the foundation of a meaningful space.

Building Around the Void

In a bustling city, peace requires a shift in perspective. Rather than focusing on walls and roofs, Parambil begins with the void. "We don't start by deciding how we're going to build; we start with the green space we want to create," he explains. By prioritising unbuilt areas, architecture becomes a tool to protect open space. Whether a house looks outward toward a view or inward to a private sanctuary, the goal is a sensory reprieve. "Great design isn't just meant to move your eyes; it should make you feel connected."





LIGHT AND SHADE
Sun bathed central courtyard at House of Quad (left); a shaded passage runs along a shallow waterbody seamlessly linking the living room to the dining and media areas (below)

Trading Labels for Substance

If there is one trend Parambil hopes to see vanish, it is brand consciousness. He notes that many homeowners focus more on designer tags than the quality of the space itself. For him, true luxury is defined by how architecture makes an inhabitant feel and interact with their surroundings, not by the label on the furniture.

Warmth of Fine Carpentry

Modern materials offer convenience but often lack soul. Parambil advocates for the revival of traditional fine carpentry, a craft he grew up with in Kerala. As the art fades due to costs and time, he remains committed to its revival. "Nobody wants to do wood anymore," he laments, yet he believes the warmth and detail of expert carpentry remain irreplaceable.

At 36, Parambil has built a portfolio that many don't reach until much later. He realised that he wasn't built for a traditional corporate structure. "I figured out very early that I would never be good working for someone else. I had to derive my own process." For his studio, the future isn't about increasing volume, they already balance roughly 20 projects across residential, hospitality and institutional sectors. Instead, the focus is on growth. "We want the next project to be better than the last," he says. By encouraging his team to sketch and stay curious, he ensures the studio keeps pushing the boundaries of what architecture can achieve.